

# Realme 13+ 5G

## The right pick for gamers

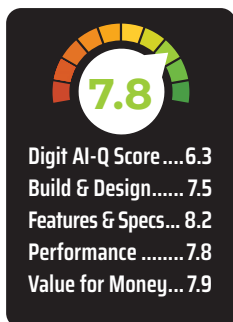
**R**ealme has been leaning heavily into catering to the mobile gaming market in 2024 with launches like the powerful Realme P1 and, now, the Realme 13+ 5G. Powered by the Snapdragon 7 Gen 3 processor, this phone looks like a gaming beast on paper equipped with a large 6050mm<sup>2</sup> Stainless Steel VC cooling system, 90 FPS gaming support on popular titles like BGMI and Call of Duty: Mobile, and GT Mode support. But it's important to note that over the last few years, Realme has also been building a portfolio of well-designed phones with stellar cameras at an affordable price; so the question that's on my mind is: has Realme sacrificed aesthetics and camera quality to make a powerful gaming phone? It has much to prove with competition like the Motorola Edge 50 Fusion, iQOO Z9, and OnePlus Nord CE4 Lite. So, let's see how the Realme 13+ 5G fares in our full review.

### BUILD AND DESIGN

My first impression of the Realme 13+ 5G was that recent Realme phones seem to have taken a step back in terms of design and aesthetics. The Realme 13+, in particular, appears quite garish, especially in the Victory Gold colour variant I received for review. Of the three available colours, I prefer the Dark Purple variant. The phone has a plastic back with wave-like patterns on the lower half and a simple matte design on the top half.

The top half features a large camera module that includes a 50 MP primary camera, a 2 MP portrait or mono camera, an LED flash, and what appears to be a dummy camera lens. This module is encircled by a slightly oblong outer ring, which has the camera specifications engraved on it.

₹22,999



One aspect of the Realme 13+ 5G's design that I appreciate is the matte, fingerprint-resistant finish on the rear panel and the frame. The buttons, however, feel quite mushy; I would prefer them to be a bit tighter. On the front, the bezels are slightly thick but nearly uniform all the way around, which I find appealing. The optical in-display fingerprint sensor is also quite speedy. The phone also comes with IP65 dust and water resistance. There's also a 3.5 mm audio jack, which has become increasingly rarer over the years.

The in-hand feel of the Realme 13+ 5G is decent; the phone isn't too slippery, and its curved back sits comfortably in my palm. However, this is far from my favourite design on a Realme phone.

### DISPLAY

The Realme 13+ 5G features a smooth and crisp 6.67-inch OLED display with Full HD+ resolution and a 120 Hz refresh rate. The display supports

HDR10+ and is Widevine L1 certified. It also includes ProXDR technology, which enhances the brightness of highlights when viewing HDR photos or videos. Additionally, the display is equipped with Rainwater Smart Touch, ensuring it works seamlessly even when wet.

HDR videos appear crisp with good detail and decent color accuracy. However, the phone encountered an issue where it wouldn't boot up Netflix, even after a fresh installation. Hopefully, Realme will address this problem soon – watch this space for updates on this matter.

The display's brightness levels are impressive as well. With a rated peak brightness of 2,000 nits, the Realme 13+ 5G's display reached 1,128 nits under direct sunlight in Auto Brightness Mode during our tests using a lux meter. Overall, this is a stellar display for the price, but the Netflix issue is concerning and should be resolved promptly.

### PERFORMANCE

The Realme 13+ 5G is in its element when handling strenuous tasks and intensive games. Powered by the Snapdragon 7 Gen 3, the Realme 13+ 5G outperforms most of its competitors in benchmarks except the more affordable iQOO Z9. It boasts up to 12 GB of LPDDR4X RAM and up to 256 GB of UFS 3.1 storage. The phone also houses a massive stainless steel vapour chamber cooling system which keeps temperatures under check.

In synthetic benchmarks, the Realme 13+ impresses with an AnTuTu score of over 7.3 lakh. In GeekBench, the phone scores a respectable 1052 points in the Single Core test and a whopping 2976 points in the Multi-Core test. Its scores are one of the best in PCMark Work too. As for GPU benchmarks, the Realme 13+ beats both the Motorola Edge 50 Fusion and OnePlus Nord CE4 Lite in all tests but the iQOO Z9 skirts ahead with superior GPU power.

The phone also doesn't throttle extensively under high loads. In the CPU Throttling Test, the phone throttled to merely 81% of its peak perfor-